

# Dalian Red 5 – 大连红五

*A 4-player climbing game with a stripped double deck, escalating solo bids, and no bombs*

## Setup

**Players:** 4. Either everyone plays for themselves, or one **declarer** plays alone against the other three.

**Cards:** Use 2 standard 54-card decks. Keep only 5s, 10s, J, Q, K, A, 2s, and Jokers. This gives exactly **60 cards**: 8 cards of each kept rank, plus 4 Jokers.

**Deal:** 15 cards to each player.

**First speaker:** Flip one Heart 10 face up before shuffling and shuffle it back in as the **special 10**. Whoever receives it declares first. If nobody declares, they lead; otherwise the declarer leads.

**House option:** In repeated rounds, the player after the previous declarer speaks first instead.

## Card Rank

**Highest to lowest:** Heart 5 > Big Joker > Small Joker > other 5s > 2 > A > K > Q > J > 10.

The **Heart 5** is separate from the other 5s. It cannot combine with other-suit 5s in pairs, sets, connected sets, or 8-of-a-kind checks. The two Heart 5s may still pair with each other.

## Declarations

Starting with the special-10 player, players declare in order. A player may choose **No Solo** or claim a contract. Later players may overcall only with a stronger contract.

| Declaration     | Contract                                                            |
|-----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>No Solo</b>  | Decline a contract. If everyone chooses this, there is no declarer. |
| <b>Solo</b>     | Declarer must go out before any opponent.                           |
| <b>Shutout</b>  | Declarer must go out before any opponent has played any card.       |
| <b>Heavenly</b> | Every declarer play must be unbeatable, including the final play.   |

**Overcalling:** After a **Solo**, later players may only choose No Solo, Shutout, or Heavenly. After a **Shutout**, later players may only choose No Solo or Heavenly. A **Heavenly** call ends the auction.

The final player to claim the highest contract becomes **declarer**. The declarer plays alone against the other three players.

## Turn Flow

A lead may be any legal play. On your turn, either **pass** or play a legal combination that **beats the current play**. If all other active players pass, the last player who played clears the pile and leads again. Passing does **not** lock you out. Players with no cards left drop out and are skipped.

## Legal Plays

| Play                  | Requirement                                                                                                                        |
|-----------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Single</b>         | 1 card.                                                                                                                            |
| <b>Pair</b>           | 2 equal-rank cards. The two Heart 5s may pair.                                                                                     |
| <b>Set</b>            | 3 to 7 equal-rank cards: triple, quad, 5-, 6-, or 7-of-a-kind.                                                                     |
| <b>Single run</b>     | Exactly 4 or 5 consecutive singles, using only 10, J, Q, K, A.                                                                     |
| <b>Connected sets</b> | 3+ consecutive equal-size groups: connected pairs, triples, quads, 5-, 6-, or 7-of-a-kind groups. Only 10, J, Q, K, A may be used. |

**Comparison:** A play only beats the **same type** with matching size, length, and structure. Connected sets must match both group size and number of groups. Sets compare by rank. Runs and connected sets compare by their highest card or highest group.

**No bombs:** There are no bombs and no cross-type beating.

## Contract End

**No Solo:** The round ends after three players have gone out; the remaining player is fourth.

**Solo:** Declarer wins by going out before any opponent. If any opponent goes out first, declarer loses immediately.

**Shutout:** Declarer wins by going out before any opponent plays any card. If any opponent plays a card before the declarer goes out, declarer loses immediately.

**Heavenly:** Every declarer play must be unbeatable when played, including the final play. If an opponent can show a legal higher matching play, declarer loses immediately.

## 8-of-a-Kind

There is no playable 8-of-a-kind. If a player is dealt **8 cards of the same ordinary rank** – 10, J, Q, K, A, or 2 – the round ends immediately and that player scores as a **Shutout** winner.

If multiple players have 8-of-a-kind, all such players score simultaneous Shutout wins; they also pay each other.

## Scoring

Scores are in base points. Contract scores are paid between the declarer and each of the three opponents.

| Result                | Player | Others   |
|-----------------------|--------|----------|
| <b>No Solo: 1st</b>   | +2     | –        |
| <b>No Solo: 2nd</b>   | +1     | –        |
| <b>No Solo: 3rd</b>   | –1     | –        |
| <b>No Solo: 4th</b>   | –2     | –        |
| <b>Solo wins</b>      | +9     | –3 each  |
| <b>Solo loses</b>     | –9     | +3 each  |
| <b>Shutout wins</b>   | +15    | –5 each  |
| <b>Shutout loses</b>  | –15    | +5 each  |
| <b>Heavenly wins</b>  | +30    | –10 each |
| <b>Heavenly loses</b> | –30    | +10 each |